Use ChatGPT to Write Down Where Mom Stands Today, Before Medicaid Is a Question

Four prompts to write down what your family believes about Medicaid, make a dated snapshot of what you know, note what has changed hands or might, and agree on what would prompt another look.

Where you are

Mom is managing, and nobody is applying for anything. You've heard that Medicaid can help pay for long-term care, and you've also heard she would never qualify. You realize you don't know what Medicaid would look at.

This guide gives you four ChatGPT prompts to organize what you already know and to see what you don't know yet. It is preparation, not an assessment. Use only information you have permission to share, with names and account numbers removed. The AI organizes and drafts; it does not determine eligibility, give legal or financial advice, or decide. Medicaid rules vary by state. Bring eligibility questions to your Medicaid planner and legal questions to an elder law attorney.

What you'll have at the end

You have a dated snapshot of what you know and don't know, a list of questions for a professional, and a short list of changes that would prompt another look.

A one-page snapshot: Where things stand today, What we don't know, Questions for a professional, and What would prompt another look.

Before you start

- What you've heard or assumed about Medicaid, however vague.
- A rough list of Mom's income, accounts, and property. Estimates are fine; leave account numbers out.
- Anything the family has given, transferred, or retitled in recent years, or is thinking about. Two of the three is plenty.

PROMPT 1

Write down what you believe about Medicaid

WHY THIS MATTERS

Most families carry a few beliefs about Medicaid that nobody has checked: she has too much money, it's only for people with nothing, the house would count. With time on your side, you can find out which ones fit Mom's state and situation. Start by writing them down.

WHAT YOU'LL NEED

What you and your relatives believe about Medicaid, and where each idea came from if you remember.

COPY THIS PROMPT

> Nothing is urgent; we are planning ahead. Here is what our family believes about Medicaid and long-term care, and where we think each idea came from:
>
> [PASTE YOUR NOTES]
>
> Make a table with three columns: WHAT WE BELIEVE, WHERE IT CAME FROM, and WHAT WE WOULD NEED TO CONFIRM. Do not tell me whether any belief is correct, and do not add Medicaid rules, limits, or dollar figures of your own. The rules vary by state, and I will confirm them with a professional.

WHAT TO LOOK FOR

Beliefs with no clear source. Those are assumptions, not facts.

WHAT TO DO NEXT

Keep the table. The third column becomes your question list.

PROMPT 2

Make a dated snapshot of what you know

WHY THIS MATTERS

A readiness review compares where Mom stands with the rules that apply to her. The rules are a professional's job. Where she stands is something your family can start writing down today, with a date on it.

WHAT YOU'LL NEED

Your rough list of Mom's income, accounts, property, and insurance, and whether she is married.

COPY THIS PROMPT

> I'm writing down where my mother stands today so we have a starting point. Nothing is wrong right now. Here is what I know about her income, accounts, property, insurance, and household:
>
> [PASTE YOUR NOTES, WITHOUT ACCOUNT NUMBERS]
>
> Turn this into a dated snapshot with these headings: INCOME, ACCOUNTS AND INVESTMENTS, HOME AND PROPERTY, INSURANCE, SPOUSE AND HOUSEHOLD, CARE NEEDS TODAY. Under each, put only what I wrote, and mark each item SEEN ON PAPER or REMEMBERED. Where I said nothing, write "not noted" so I can see the blank. Do not add up totals, label anything countable or exempt, or compare anything with a Medicaid limit.

WHAT TO LOOK FOR

A snapshot with the blanks showing, not a verdict.

WHAT TO DO NEXT

Put today’s date at the top and save it where you’ll find it again.

PROMPT 3

Note what has changed hands, and what might

WHY THIS MATTERS

Gifts, transfers, and changes in ownership can matter if Mom ever applies, and how they are treated depends on the state and the details. Families planning ahead are often thinking about a change, too. Both lists belong in front of a professional before anything is done.

WHAT YOU'LL NEED

What has been given, transferred, or retitled in recent years, and anything the family is considering.

COPY THIS PROMPT

> Here are two lists. First, gifts, transfers, and ownership changes involving my mother that have already happened. Second, changes our family has talked about making:
>
> [PASTE BOTH LISTS]
>
> For the first list, record what happened, roughly when, who was involved, and what paperwork exists. For the second list, turn each idea into a question to ask a professional before we do anything. Do not tell me whether any item is a problem or a good idea, do not mention any look-back period or penalty, and do not recommend any step.

WHAT TO LOOK FOR

A record of what has happened, and a list of questions in place of plans.

WHAT TO DO NEXT

Hold the ideas on the second list until a professional has seen the questions.

PROMPT 4

Agree on what would prompt another look

WHY THIS MATTERS

Planning ahead doesn’t mean reviewing this every month. It means knowing which changes are worth another look, so the rest of the time you can leave it alone.

WHAT YOU'LL NEED

The results of the first three prompts.

COPY THIS PROMPT

> Here is the starting picture I’ve put together about my mother:
>
> [PASTE THE RESULTS OF PROMPTS 1 TO 3]
>
> Write one page with four headings: WHERE THINGS STAND TODAY, WHAT WE DON’T KNOW, QUESTIONS FOR A PROFESSIONAL, and WHAT WOULD PROMPT ANOTHER LOOK. Under the last heading, list specific changes, such as a change in her health or care needs, her finances, or her marital status. Beside each question, note who we would likely ask: a Medicaid planner, an elder law attorney, a licensed financial professional, or the family first. Do not estimate whether she would qualify and do not rank the changes by likelihood.

WHAT TO LOOK FOR

A short, specific list, not everything that could happen.

WHAT TO DO NEXT

Share the page with one other family member, and keep it. It’s the start of the next step below.

Turn the snapshot into a report

A snapshot is only useful if it’s complete. The planning interview goes through your family’s situation one question at a time, including the parts you didn’t think to write down, and turns your answers into a free planning report you can bring to your Medicaid planner when the time comes.

Get Your Free Planning Report ›